



2

Australia claimed a 159-run win over West Indies in the opening Test in Barbados to go 1-0 up in the three-match series. Bowled out for 180 in the first innings, the visitor trailed by 10 runs before Travis Head, Beau Webster, and Alex Carey led a fightback to set a 301-run target. Josh Hazlewood (**in pic**) starred with a five-wicket haul, while Nathan Lyon sealed the win by taking the final two wickets in consecutive balls as the host was dismissed for 144 in the final session. Shamar Joseph's resistance gave West Indies a glimmer of hope, but Australia held firm.

AP



3

Zimbabwe will make its ICC Women's Championship debut with a white-ball tour of New Zealand in March 2026. The historic campaign will begin with three ODIs at the University of Otago Oval in Dunedin, preceded by three T20Is in Hamilton. The Championship also serves as a qualification pathway for the 2029 Women's World Cup. Zimbabwe will first travel to Ireland next month for three T20Is and two ODIs.

ICC



4

Former England fast bowler David Lawrence, the first British-born Black cricketer to play for England, died at the age of 61. A highly promising pacer, Lawrence played five Tests and one ODI between 1988 and 1992 before a horrific knee injury ended his career. Off the field, he became a passionate advocate for diversity and inclusion in cricket. In 2025, he was appointed MBE in the King's Birthday Honours and named one of the ECB's inaugural Honorary Life Vice-Presidents.

AP



5

Bangladesh will host Pakistan for a three-match T20I series from July 20 to 24 in Dhaka. The teams last met in May-June in Pakistan, where the host swept the series. Currently ranked eighth and 10th in the ICC T20I rankings, respectively, both sides will use the series to fine-tune preparations for the 2026 ICC Men's T20 World Cup.

AP



6

Canada has become the 13th team to qualify for the 2026 ICC Men's T20 World Cup. It joins co-hosts India and Sri Lanka, as well as Afghanistan, Australia, Bangladesh, England, Ireland, New Zealand, Pakistan, South Africa, United States, and West Indies. Seven spots remain, to be filled via regional qualifiers — two each from Europe and Africa, and three from the Asia-East Asia-Pacific regions. Canada made its T20 World Cup debut in 2024, earning a group-stage win over Ireland.

ICC